ZOOM INSTRUCTIONS

To ensure you get the absolute most out of your online guitar lessons, whether regular or occasional, this guide is your essential roadmap.

A smooth setup is key to better lessons, so **please read through each section carefully!**

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1. LESSONS ON ZOOM:

Zoom is an excellent tool for online guitar lessons, offering **real-time interaction** and **clear demonstrations** right from the comfort of your home.

Benefits of Learning on Zoom

- **Optimal Views:** My webcam setup includes a movable arm, allowing me to provide clear, **overhead views of my hands**. This often gives you a better perspective than in-person lessons.
- **Record for Reference:** You can easily **record any part of the lesson**, saving video of my playing directly to your device for future review.

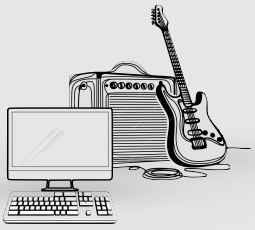
Important Considerations

- **No Real-Time Jamming:** Due to audio delay, **playing together live is not possible** on Zoom.

Zoom Lessons Are Perfect For:

All things considered, Zoom lessons are highly effective for:

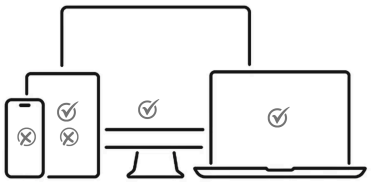
- Learning songs (including singing), solos, and specific parts
- Practicing scales, chords, and arpeggios
- Studying music theory and ear training
- Songwriting and composition
- Enjoying the convenience of learning from home



As long as your setup and internet connection are solid, I'll be able to see and hear you clearly. If you follow these guidelines, you'll have a great experience too!

2. SCREEN SIZE:

- The larger your screen, the better your overall experience will be.
- While you'll still be visible on my end with a phone screen, seeing me clearly or following shared sheet music will be challenging. For this reason, **using a phone is strongly discouraged.**
- When I use the **share screen feature** for sheet music, Zoom makes my video small. However, you can **drag the divider bar to enlarge my video** and adjust the layout to your preference. This ensures you can clearly see both the sheet music and your teacher.



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3. USING MULTIPLE SCREENS: *Optional*

- If you're using **multiple screens, even better!** You can view the shared sheet music on one screen and my video on the other. Zoom's **dual-monitor display feature** allows you to separate the video layout and shared content across two screens.
- To **enable dual monitors** in the Zoom desktop app:

    1. Sign in.
    2. Click your **profile picture** in the top-right corner.
    3. Select **Settings**.
    4. Go to the **General** tab.
    5. Check the box for **"Enable dual monitor mode"** under "Meeting window mode."

You can also use your tablet as a second monitor for your desktop to achieve this setup. For specific instructions, you'll need to check online resources for your tablet and computer.

4. SETTING UP YOUR SPACE:

Getting your space ready before your lesson starts is key to a smooth and productive learning experience. Here's how to set yourself up for success:

- **Find Your Spot:** Choose a **quiet, well-lit place** where you won't be interrupted. This helps you focus and ensures your instructor can see and hear you clearly.
- **Check Your Lighting:** Make sure your primary light source is **facing you**, not behind you. If there are bright windows or lights behind you, close the blinds or turn them off. This prevents you from appearing as a silhouette and keeps you clearly visible.
- **Stable Surface for Your Device:** Place your computer, laptop, or tablet on a **stable, flat surface**. This prevents wobbling and ensures a consistent view for your instructor.
- **Tablet Users, Listen Up!** If you're using a tablet, simply leaning it against something usually isn't enough, especially since you'll likely need to tilt it to show your guitar. I highly recommend **investing in a good tablet stand** that offers a variety of angles. This will allow you to position your camera perfectly to show your fretboard and picking hand.
- **Chair Choice Matters:** This is a big one for guitarists! **Always use a chair with no arms.** Trying to play guitar on a chair with arms is like trying to drive with the parking brake on—it's restrictive and will definitely hold you back from good posture and technique.



5. GETTING STARTED:

- Sign in to your Zoom account
- If you don’t have one yet, create an account at <**www.zoom.com**>. Make sure you’re signed in.
- **Download the Zoom app** on your device — desktop, laptop, or tablet.

6. YOUR CONNECTION:

- **Avoid other people using heavy internet** (streaming, gaming) at the same time — it helps keep the Zoom connection smooth.
- **Close any other applications and background windows**, as they can slow down your device's performance.
- Try to **be as close to your Wi-Fi router** as possible, **or consider a wired Ethernet connection** for maximum stability.

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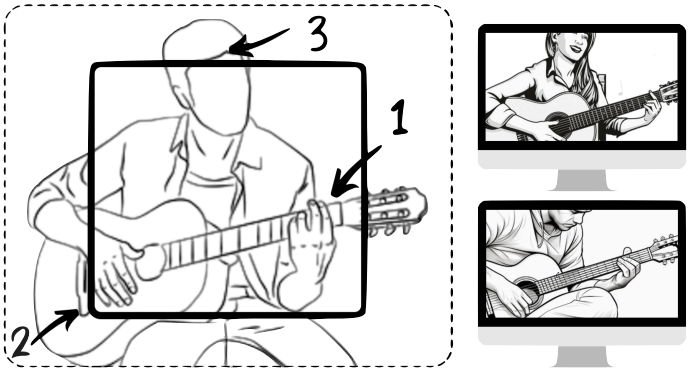
7. JOIN THE MEETING:

- You'll need the Zoom meeting invitation.
- Meeting ID stays the **same every time**.
- **RED PICK MUSIC** lesson room: **https://us02web.zoom.us/j/3404335872**

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8. CAMERA FRAMING GUIDELINES:

- Please position your camera so that your guitar and picking hand are within the frame, but ensure you're close enough to clearly see the sheet music I screen-share.
- **I need a clear view** of your picking area and the nut (0th fret) on your guitar; the nut serves as my reference point for your position on the neck.
- You don't need to show anything above your eyes or to the left of your picking hand.



9. SOUND SETTINGS:

- Headsets ideal for work meetings often aren't suitable for guitar lessons. Their close-proximity microphones may not adequately capture the full sound of your guitar.
- Zoom is optimized for speech, not music. By default, it tends to filter out musical instruments like a guitar, often treating the sound as background noise. To prevent this, a few settings need to be adjusted.

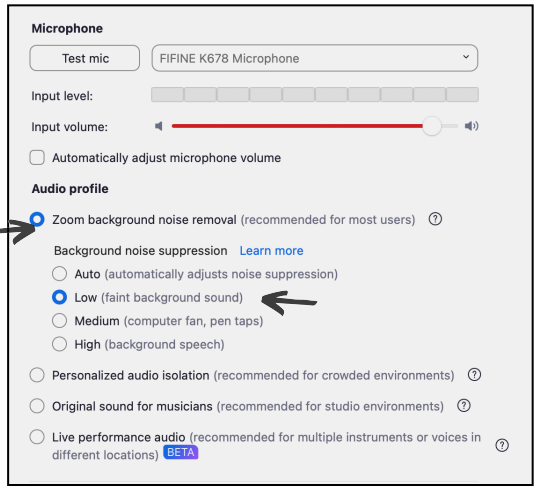
Computer Set-Up

- Go to **audio settings**.
- Turn off "**Automatically adjust microphone volume.**" This prevents Zoom from continuously altering your input levels during your playing.
- Set "**Noise Suppression**" to "**Low.**" This helps ensure your guitar sound is not inadvertently muted.
- **(Optional, but generally not recommended)** Enable "Original Sound for Musicians." This setting disables Zoom's default audio filtering, aiming for a more natural sound. However, it can sometimes block certain notes. We can test this option together during our lesson to determine if it's suitable for your specific setup.

For Desktop

Tablet & Phone Set-Up:

- Manual noise suppression **level adjustments are not available on mobile devices**. Instead, you'll need to:
- If using a browser, navigate to **zoom.us**, then go to **Settings > Audio**, and enable "**Original Sound for Musicians.**"
- Within the Zoom mobile app, tap "**More,**" then "**Enable Original Sound.**" This is the only method to reduce sound filtering on mobile and tablet devices.



Once you've followed these steps, you're all set!